Lesson 2 — The Lost Photographs

Part 1 of 12: Passage — The Lost Photographs

Level: A1+ → A2 (second step)

About 20 minutes · this part carries a sheet and audio

> How to do the listening. Same rule as Lesson 1: the student listens twice with no text, then reads. Audio files: `01-passage.mp3` first, then the other parts in order. Part `05-ed-sounds.mp3` is new — a past-simple verb drill.

1.1 Before listening (2 minutes, Arabic is fine here)

1. What is on your phone that you would not want to lose?
2. Have you ever lost a phone, a file, or a photograph?
3. Where do you keep a second copy of important things?

1.4 Now read the passage

Passage: The Lost Photographs (244 words)

Last year, Maha was a student at a college in Gaza. She studied design, and she loved her work. Every week she took photographs of her city — the market, the sea, the old streets. She kept all of them on her phone.

[A] One morning in May, Maha put her phone in her bag and went to college. At eleven o'clock, she opened the bag. The phone was not there. She looked everywhere, but she did not find it.

[B] She was sad about the phone, but she was much sadder about the photographs. There were more than two thousand of them, and she had no other copy. Three years of work disappeared in one morning.

[C] Her teacher listened to her story and asked one question: "Did you have a backup?" Maha did not know the word. The teacher explained it in a simple way. A backup is a second copy of your files in another place. If you lose the first copy, you still have the second one.

[D] That week, Maha learned how to make backups. She copied her new photographs to a laptop. She also copied the most important ones to a memory card, and she kept the card at home. When the internet was good, she sent some folders to an online drive.

Maha still remembers her lost photographs. But now she says the same thing to every new student: "Your phone is not a safe place. It is only one place."

1.5 Read aloud

Read the passage aloud once and record it. Compare it with your Lesson 1 recording: are the sentences easier now?